RENTALSCAPE · CUSTOMER PORTAL

City of Pasadena, CA Short-Term Rental Permit and Tax Portal

A step-by-step guide for permit holders, covering the permit application from account creation through payment, and the quarterly tax reporting and remittance that follows.

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July 27, 2026

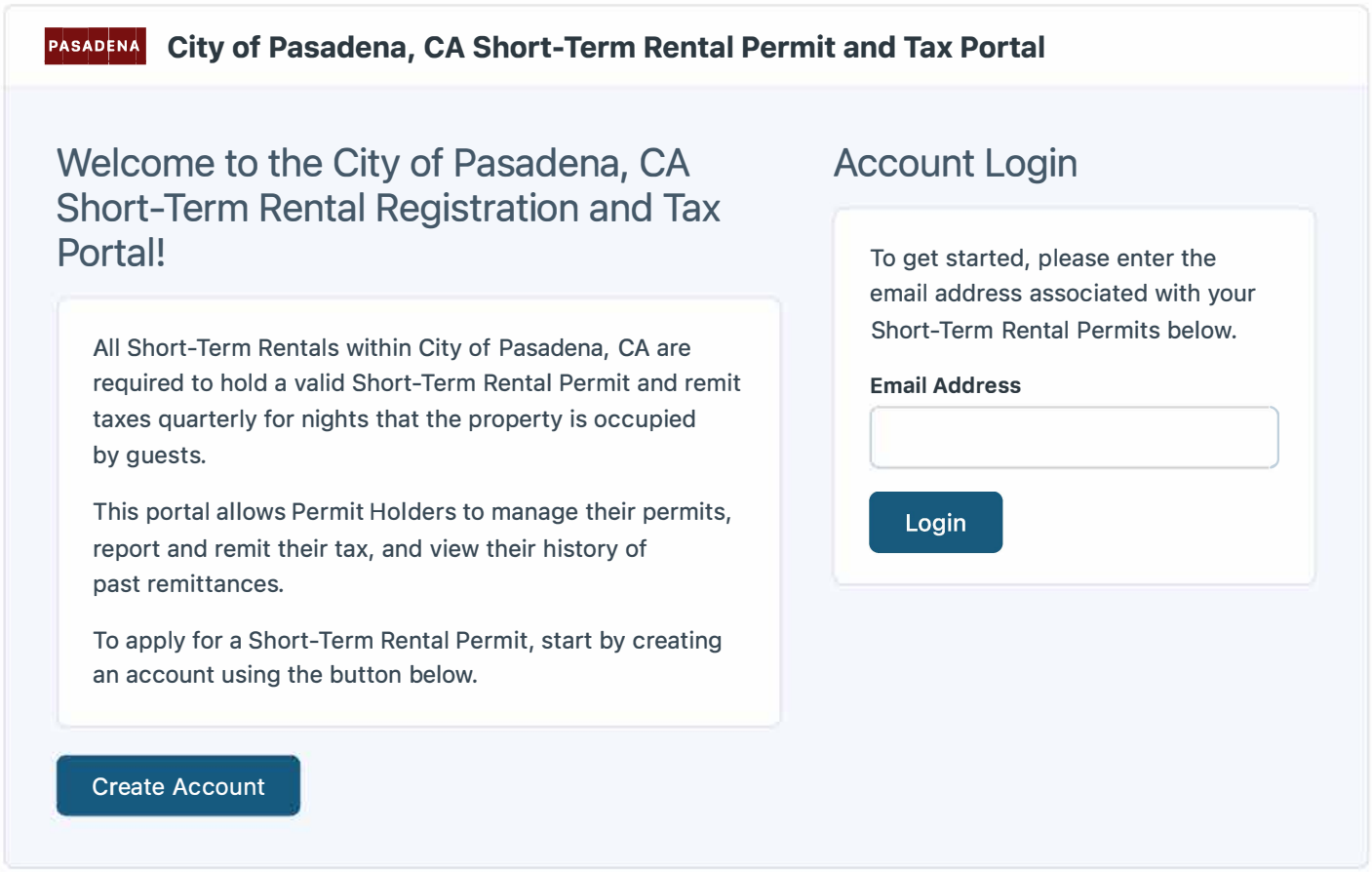
1. Portal landing

Getting Started

All short-term rentals within City of Pasadena, CA are required to hold a valid Short-Term Rental Permit and to remit taxes quarterly for nights that the property is occupied by guests.

To apply for a permit, click **Create Account**. If you already have an account, enter the email address associated with your permits in the Account Login panel on the right-hand side of the page and click **Login**.

You can use the same account to manage permits for multiple properties, so property managers and owners of more than one short-term rental should not create separate accounts.



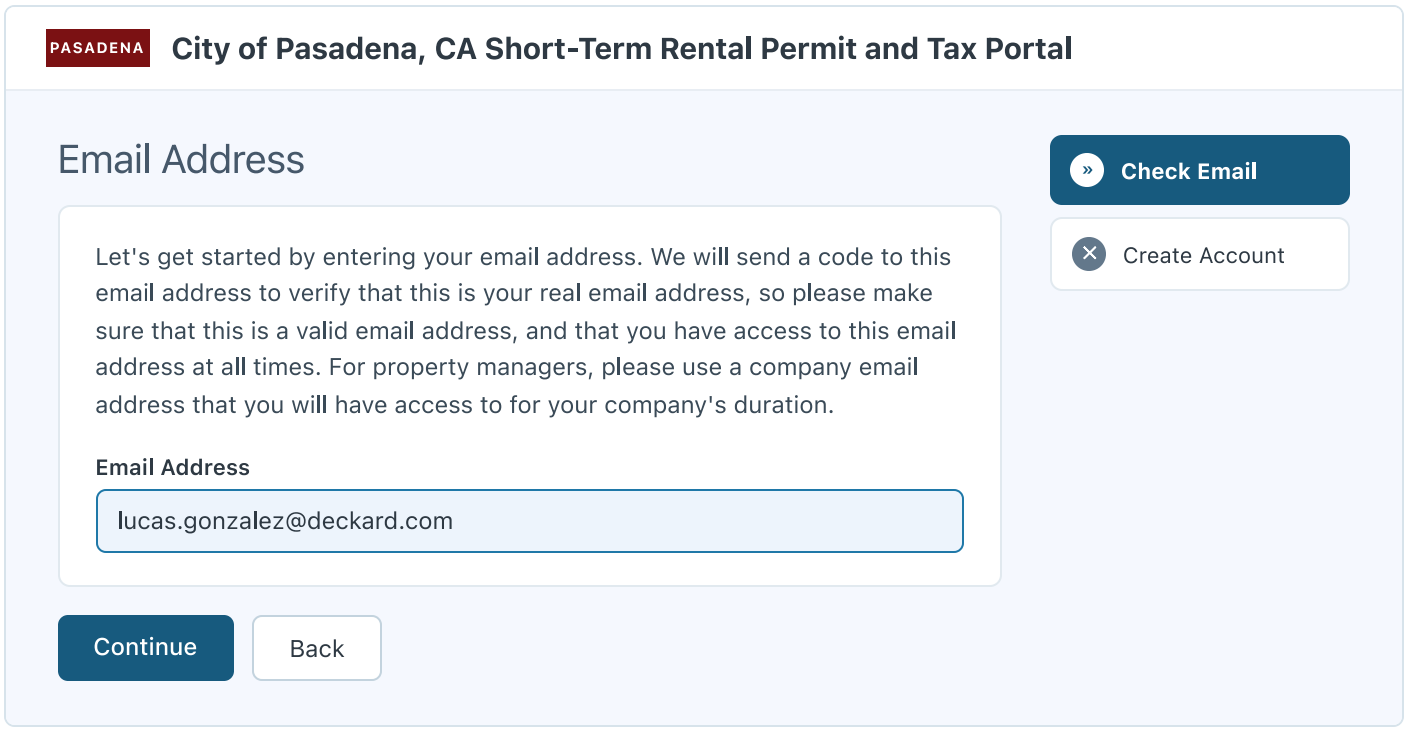
2. Creating an account

Verifying Your Email Address

Enter your email address. A verification code is sent to that address to confirm it is real and reachable before any application data is collected.

> Choose an address you will have access to for the duration of the permit. Email addresses cannot be updated on your account at this time. Property managers should use a company address rather than an individual employee's address.

The progress panel on the right-hand side tracks the two stages of account setup. Click **Continue** once you have entered the code sent to your inbox.

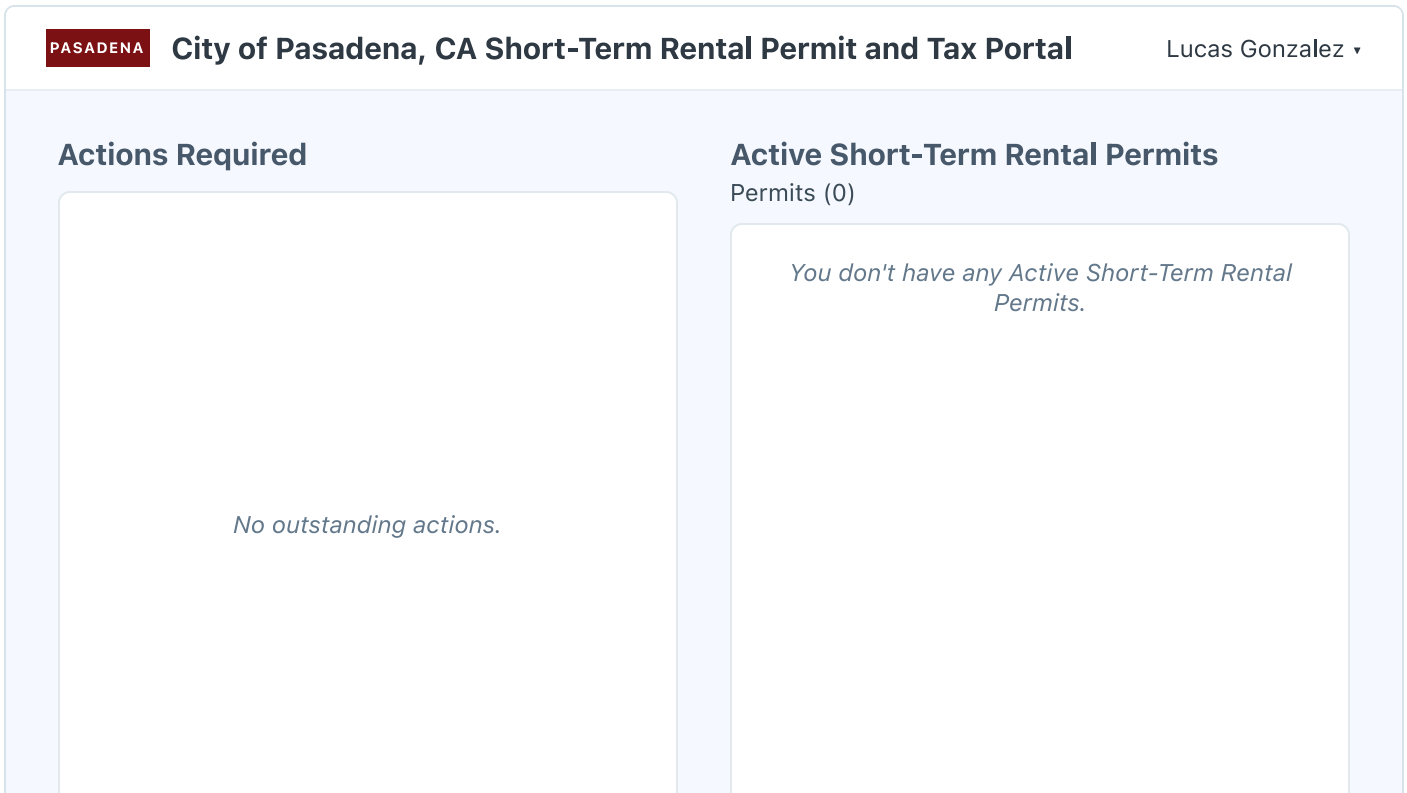


3. Permit dashboard

Your Dashboard

The dashboard is the home page for your account. **Actions Required** on the left lists anything the City needs from you. **Active Short-Term Rental Permits** on the right lists the permits held by this account.

To begin a permit application, click **Apply for new Permit**. Once you hold a permit, this panel also carries the **Pay Tax** action used for quarterly reporting, covered in Part 2 of this guide.



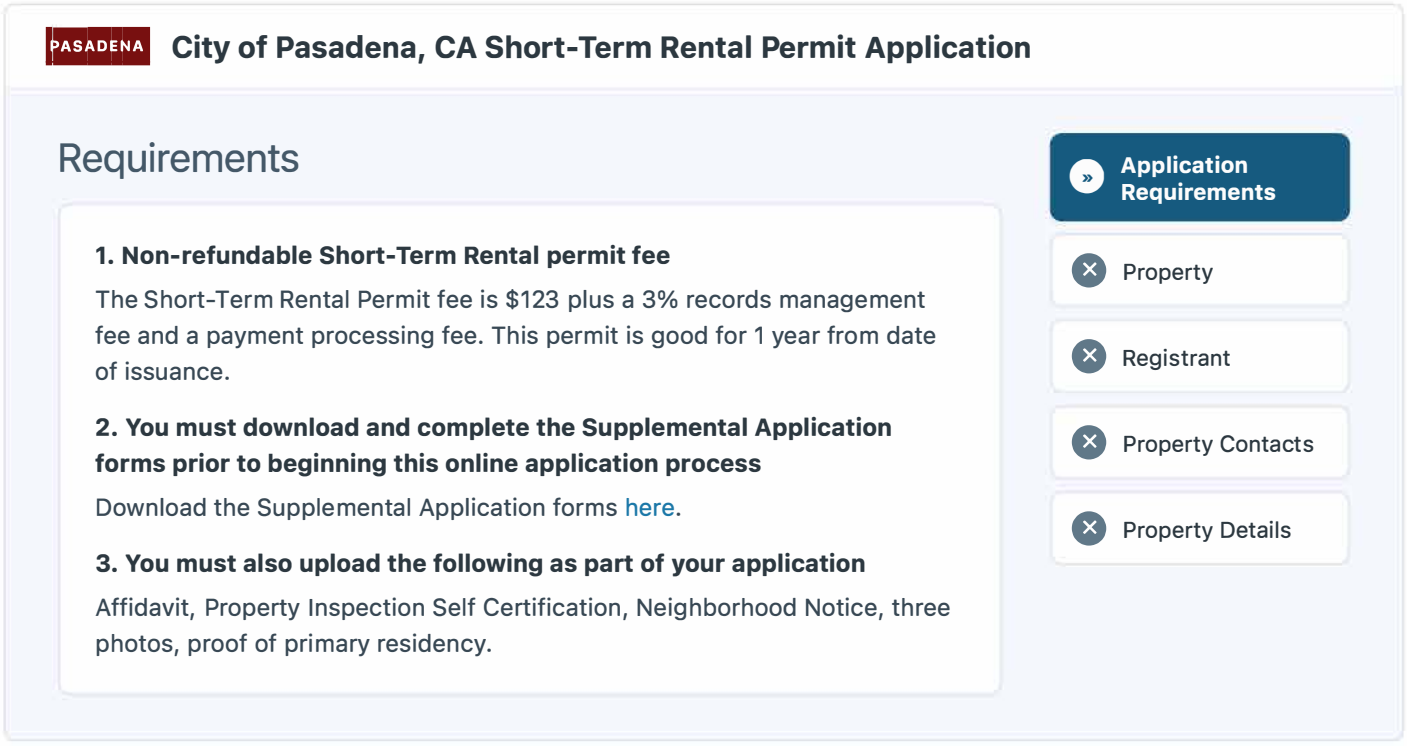


4. Application requirements

Before You Begin

The first step of the application sets out what is required. Read it in full before continuing, because several items must be completed outside the portal first.

- **Permit fee.** $123 plus a 3% records management fee and a payment processing fee. The permit is valid for 1 year from the date of issuance, and processing takes 1–2 weeks.
- **Supplemental forms.** Download and complete them before starting the online application. This includes obtaining the notary acknowledgement on the affidavit, photographing the rental, and providing the Neighborhood Notice to your neighbors.
- **Uploads.** Affidavit for Short-Term Rentals, Property Inspection Self Certification, Neighborhood Notice, three photos of the unit, and proof of primary residency.
- **Ongoing obligations.** Include your permit number on all listings, and remit TOT, TBID and booking records to the City quarterly.
- **Ordinance.** Review Section 17.50.296 of the Pasadena Municipal Code before submitting.

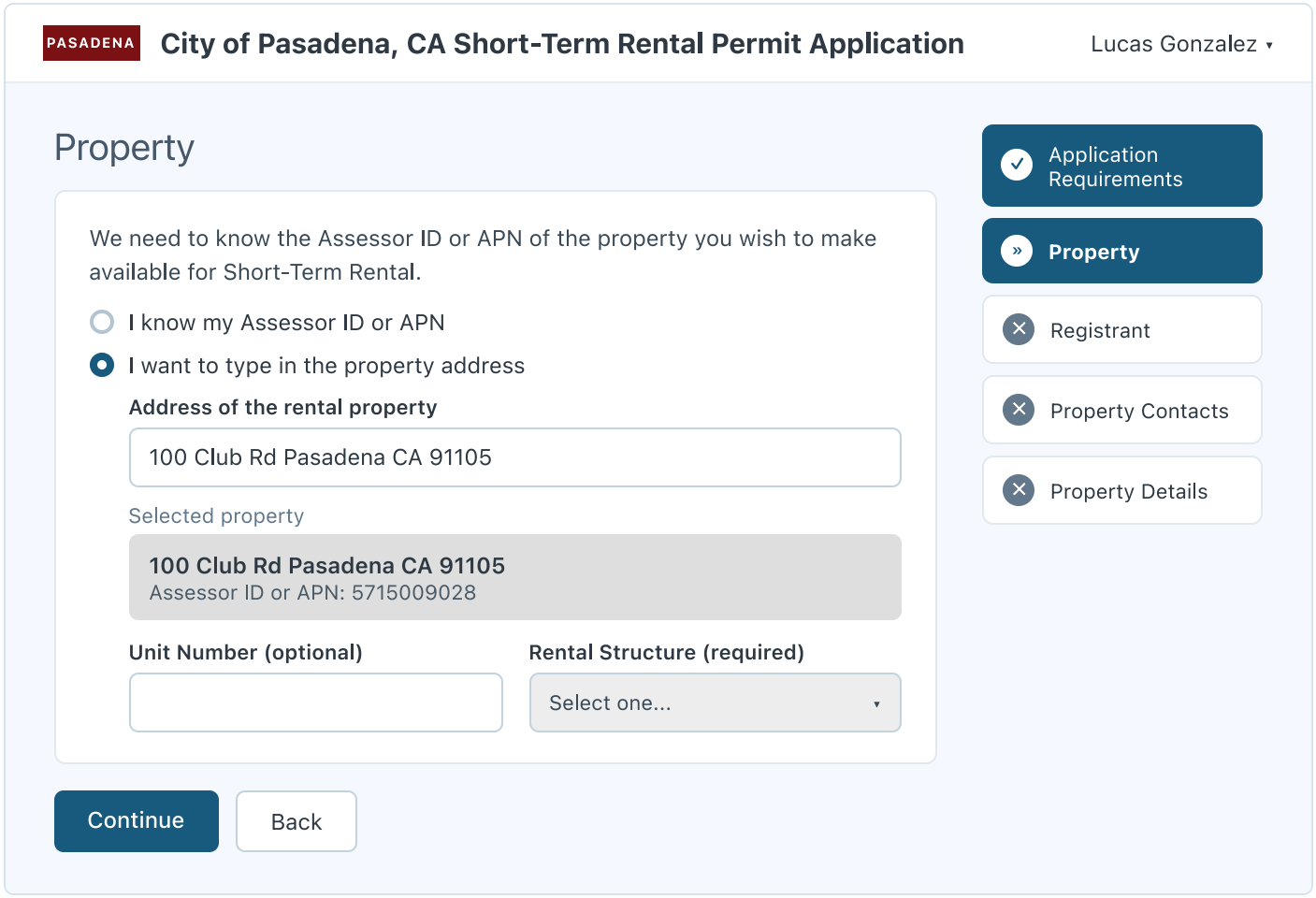


5. Property

Identifying the Property

The application must be tied to a specific parcel. Select **I know my Assessor ID or APN** and type it in, or select **I want to type in the property address** and choose your property from the results. The portal resolves the address to its Assessor ID automatically.

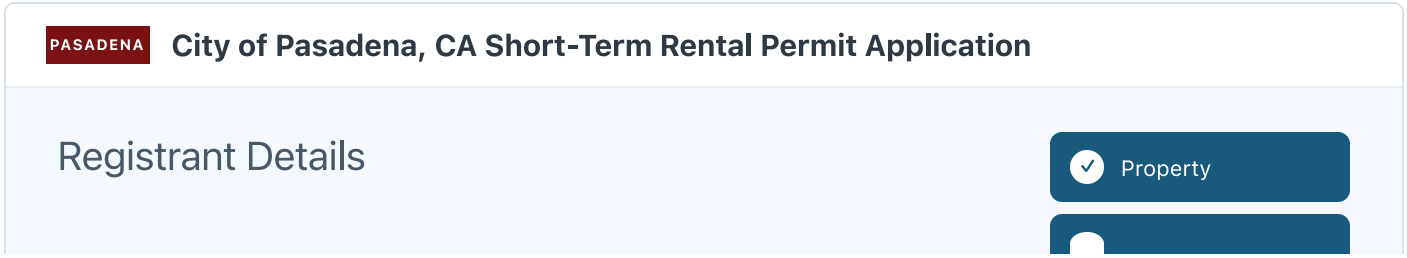
Confirm that the selected property shown below the search field is correct. Add a **Unit Number** if the rental is one unit within a larger property, then choose the **Rental Structure** that describes it.

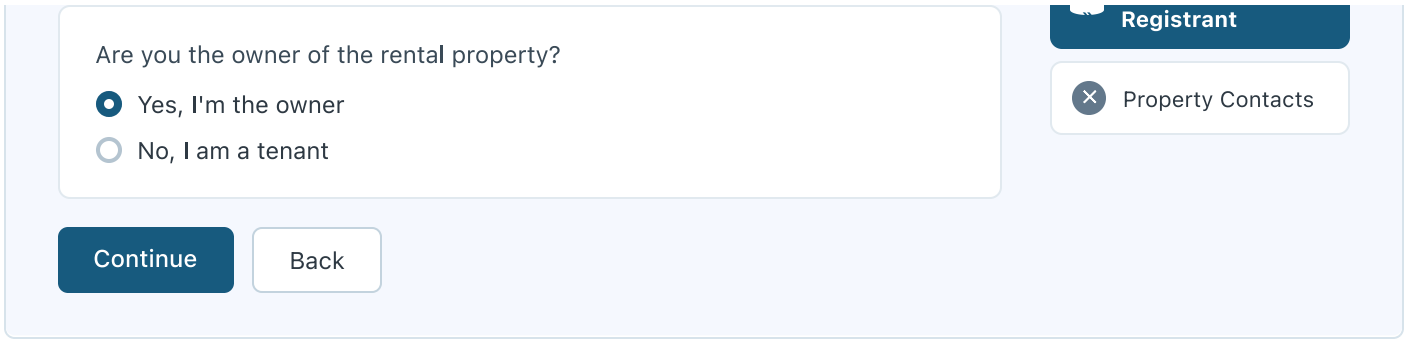


6. Registrant

Owner or Tenant

State whether you are the owner of the rental property. If you are a tenant, you will be asked for written authorization from the property owner later in the application.

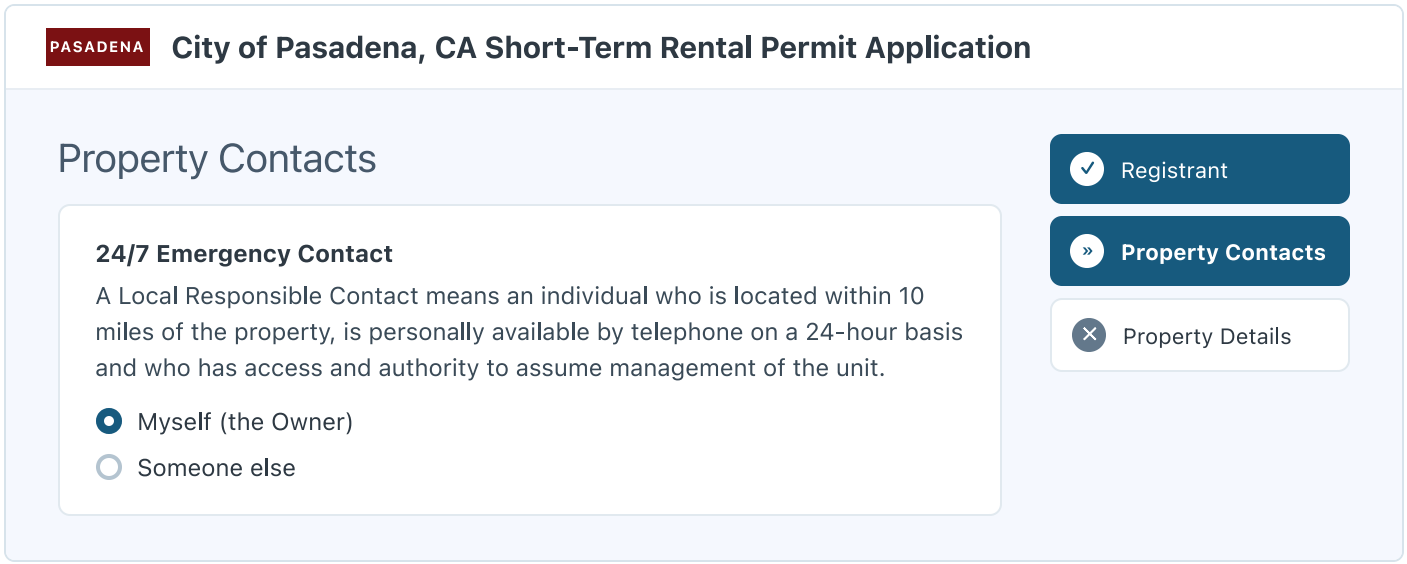




7. Property contacts

The 24/7 Emergency Contact

Every short-term rental must have a local responsible contact. This is an individual located within **10 miles** of the property, personally available by telephone 24 hours a day, with access and authority to assume management of the unit. An agent or property management company meeting these requirements may serve in this role.



8. Property details

Occupancy, Parking and Permit Type

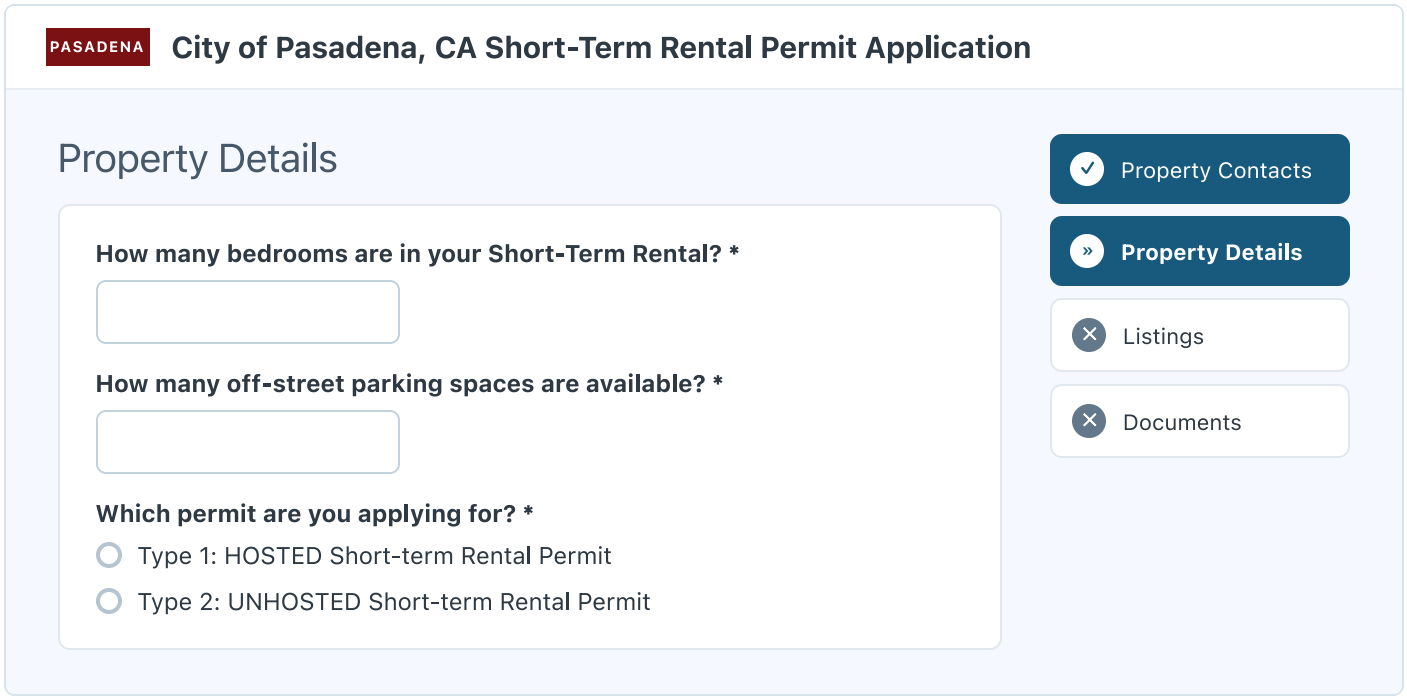
Enter the number of bedrooms and the number of off-street parking spaces available, then state whether the property is your primary residence and whether it has been short-term rented between April 1st 2018 and today.

> **Pasadena requires separate permits for hosted and unhosted rentals.** If you wish to advertise your unit for both, you must apply separately for each permit.

- **Type 1: Hosted.** You remain at the property during all guest stays.

- **Type 2: Unhosted.** You are not at the property during guest stays, you have a local responsible contact or property management company available 24 hours per day, and you will not have more than 90 days of guest stays per calendar year.

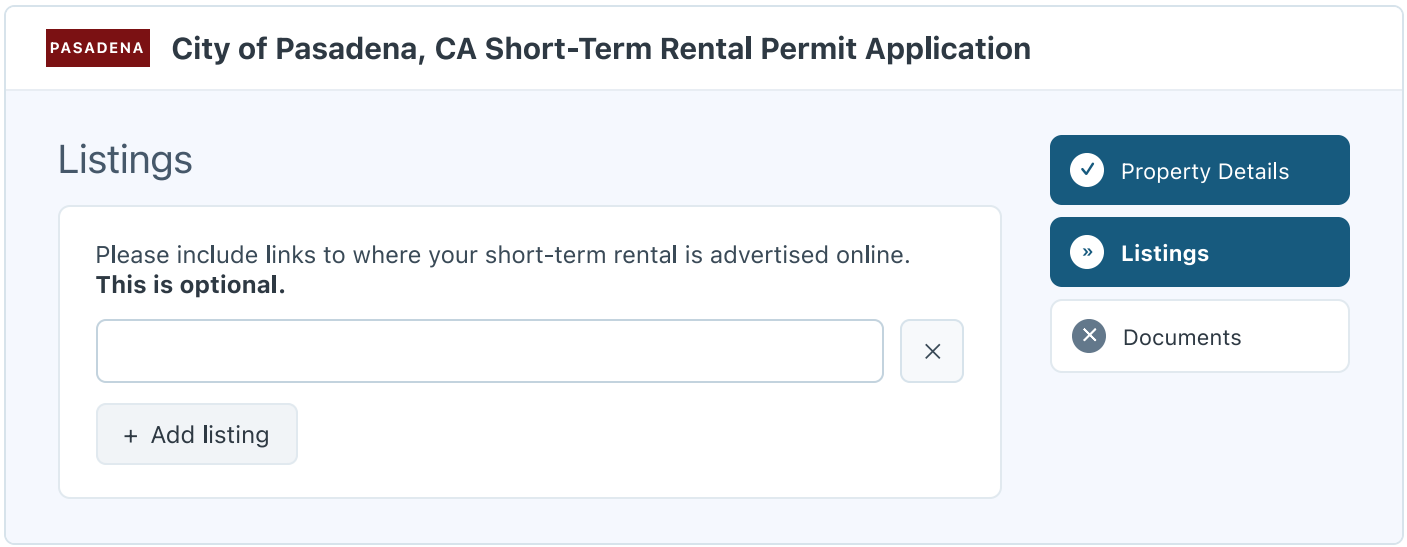
Finally, state whether you short-term rent any other properties in Pasadena.



9. Listings

Declaring Your Listings

Include links to where your short-term rental is advertised online. Use **Add listing** to enter more than one URL. This step is optional, but declaring your listings helps the City match your permit to monitored rental activity.

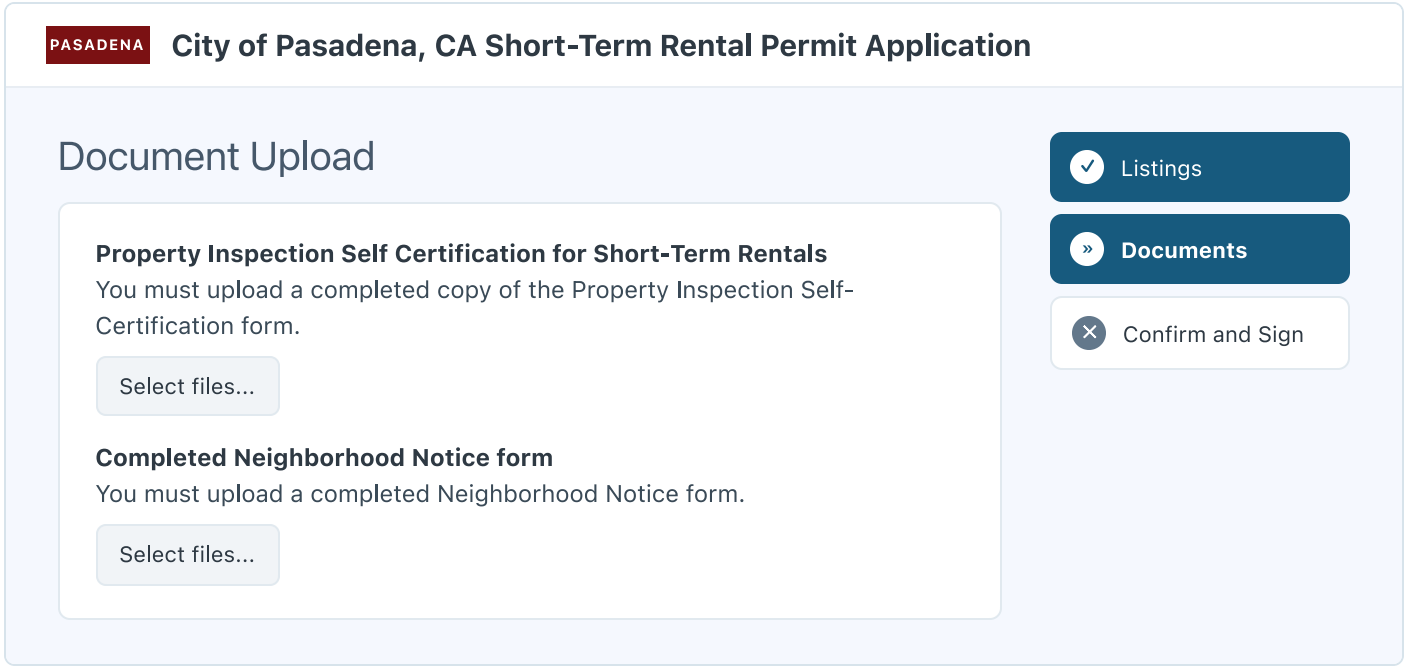


10. Documents

Uploading Your Documents

Upload each of the five required documents using the **Select files...** button beneath it. Supported formats are .jpg, .jpeg, .png, .pdf and .heic. Files must be at least 15 KB and no larger than 4 MB, with up to 20 files per document type.

- Property Inspection Self Certification for Short-Term Rentals
- Completed Neighborhood Notice form
- Three photos of the unit: interior, front entrance and exterior
- Notarized Short-Term Rental Affidavit Form
- Proof of Primary Residency — any two documents showing your name and the property address

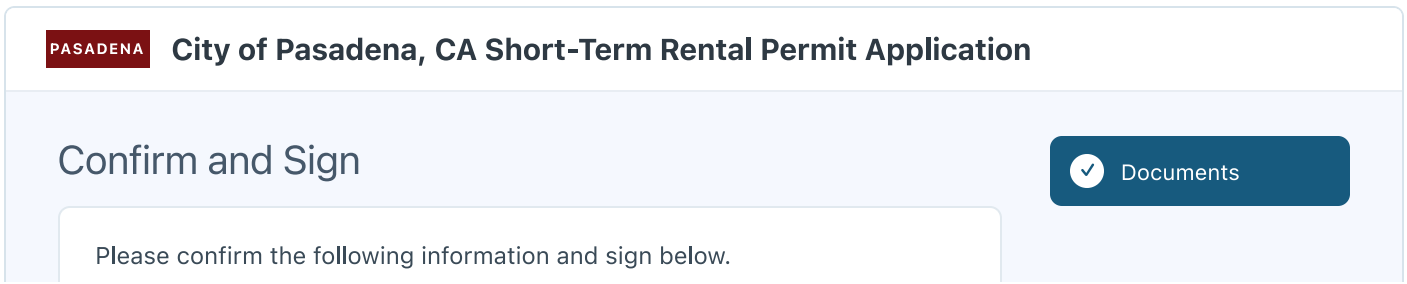


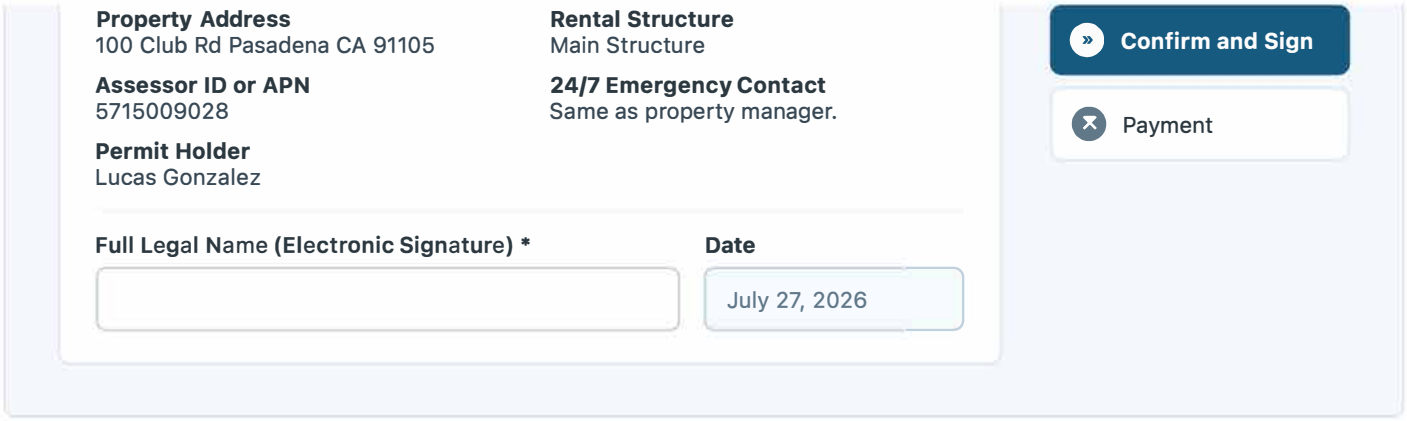
11. Confirm and sign

Reviewing and Signing

Everything you entered is played back on one page: the property address and Assessor ID, rental structure, permit holder, owners, property manager, the 24/7 emergency contact, and every document you uploaded. Check each section carefully.

Type your full legal name in the signature field to certify that the information is accurate, then click **Continue** to move to payment.





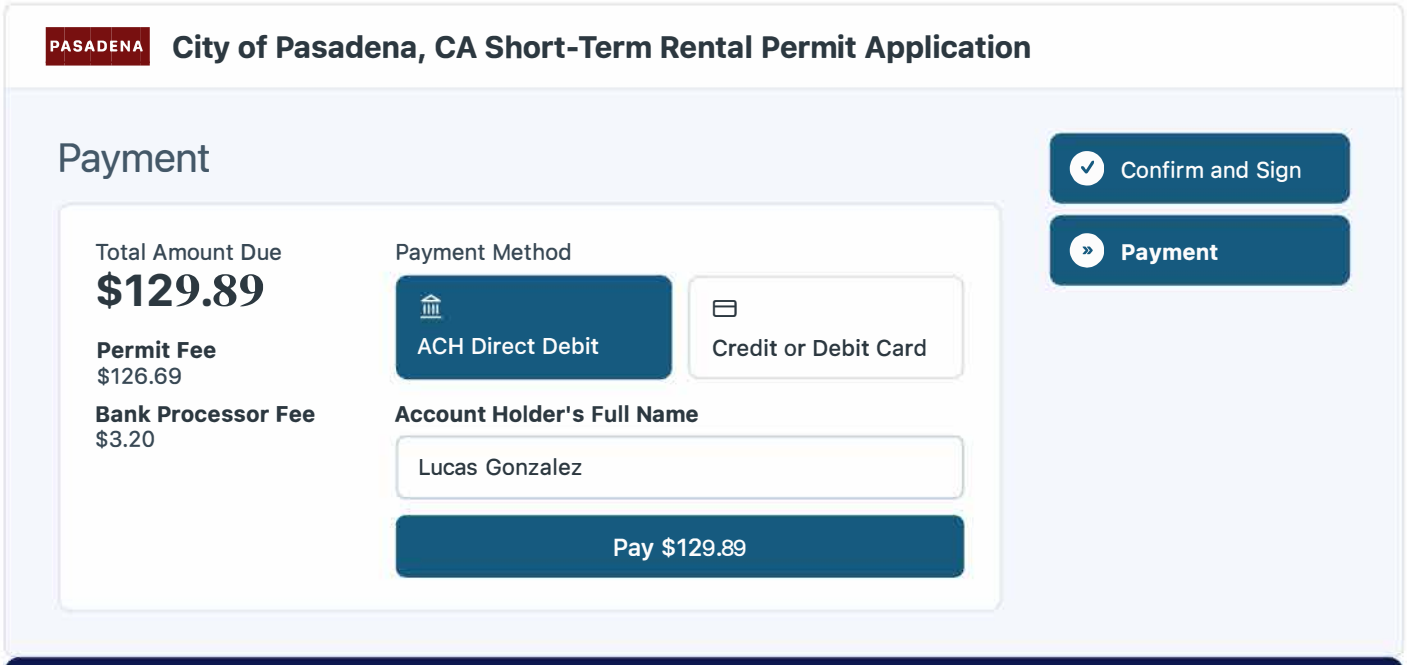
12. Payment

Paying the Permit Fee

The total is itemized so you can see the permit fee and the processor fee separately. Choose **ACH Direct Debit** or **Credit or Debit Card**, enter the account holder's name and email, and complete the payment.

> Ensure the name provided matches the name on file for the bank account, and disable any active pop-up blockers, as they can interfere with the payment process.

Once payment is complete your application moves into review with City staff. Processing takes 1–2 weeks, and your permit number is issued by email on approval.



PART 2

Quarterly Tax Reporting and Remittance

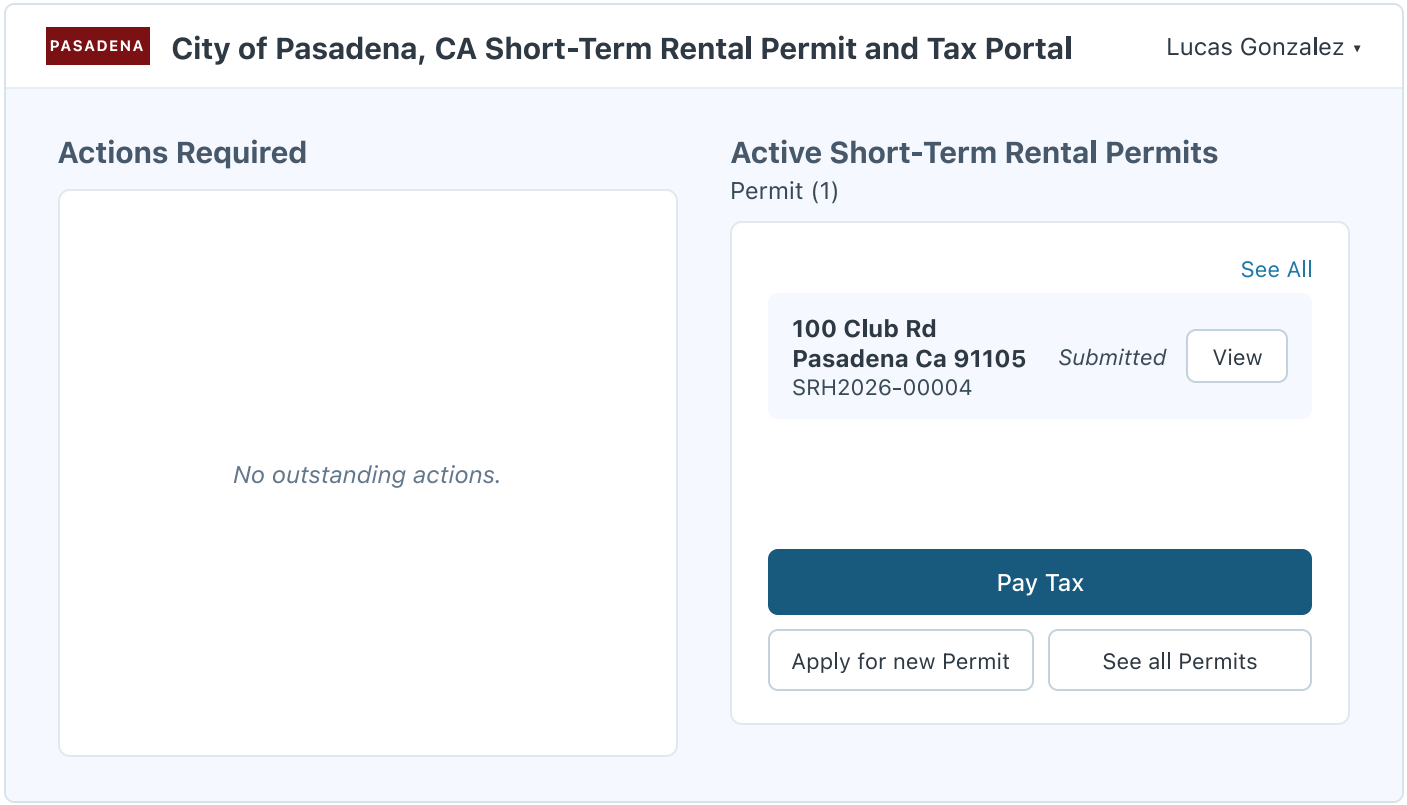
Once your permit is issued, you report revenue and remit tax each quarter through the same portal.

13. Starting a remittance

The Pay Tax Action

Reporting starts from the dashboard. Each active permit shows its permit number and status. Click **Pay Tax** to begin reporting for the current period.

> If you hold a single permit and use the **Pay Tax** action button, you bypass the Select Properties screen and go straight to Report Revenue. To report additional periods, use the alternate **Pay Tax** button on the right-hand side of the dashboard, which opens the Select Properties screen.



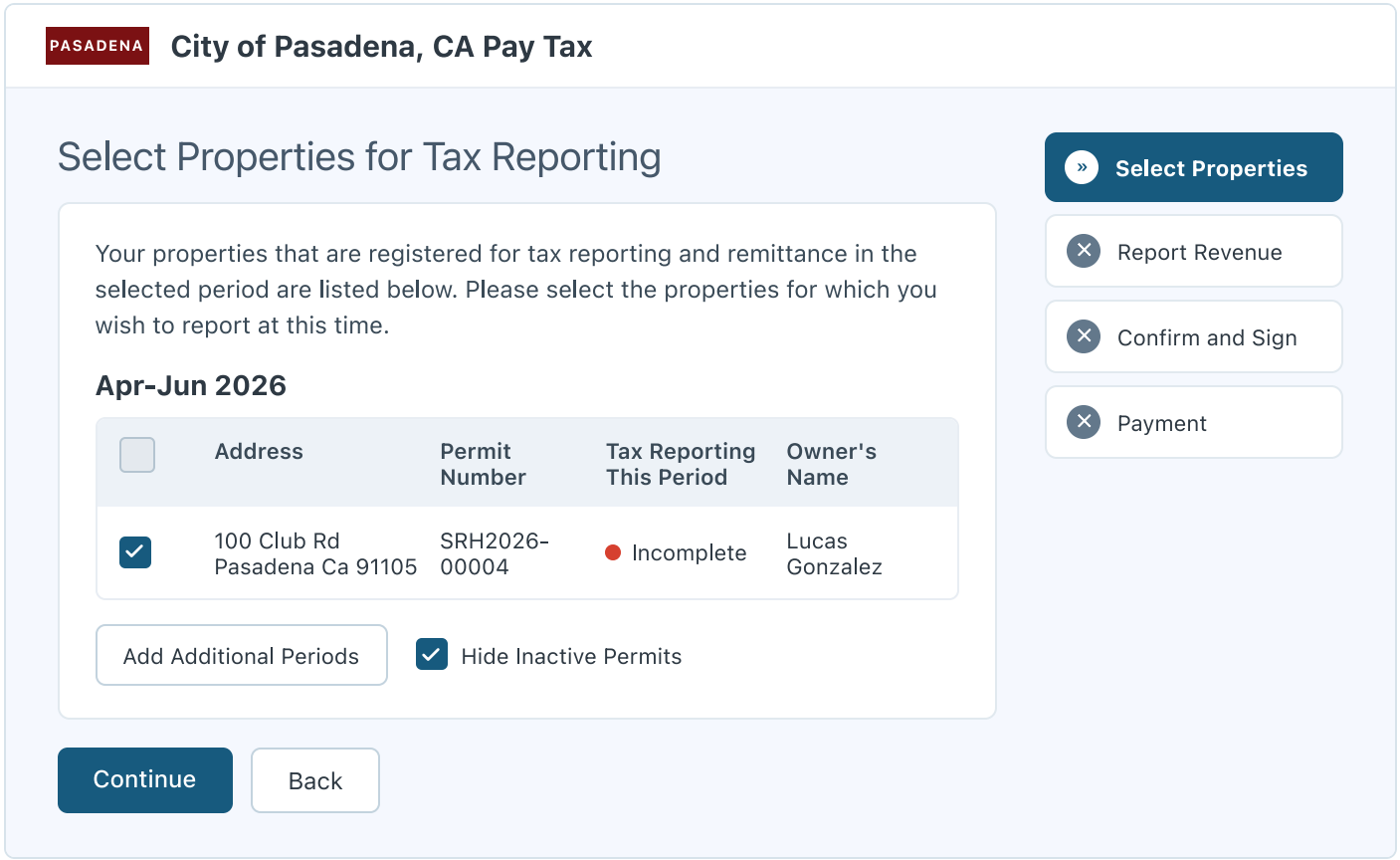
14. Select properties for tax reporting

Choosing Properties and Periods

If you hold more than one permit, the Select Properties screen lets you choose which properties to report for in this period. By default, all properties with outstanding reporting in the period are already selected.

To report more than one period at a time, click **Add Additional Periods** beneath the table and choose the periods you want to include. **Hide Inactive Permits** keeps the list to permits that still require filing.

The **Tax Reporting This Period** column shows the status of each property. Once you have selected all the properties and periods you wish to report, click **Continue**.



15. Report revenue

Reporting Occupancy and Revenue

For each property and reporting period, enter the number of days the property was available and the number of days it was occupied, then enter gross revenue for each platform grouping. Taxable receipts are calculated from what you enter.

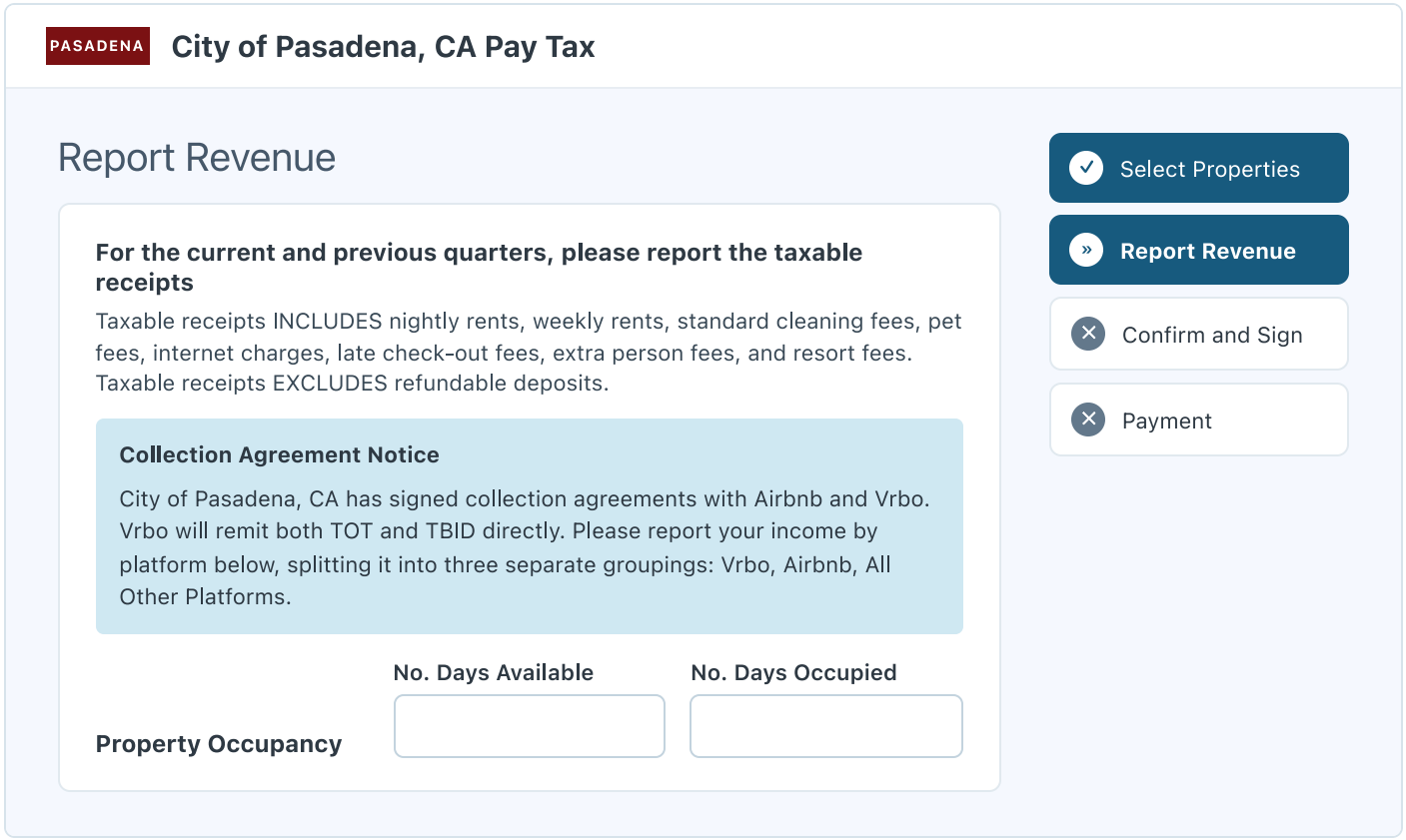
- **Taxable receipts include** nightly, weekly and standard rents, cleaning fees, pet fees, internet charges, late check-out fees, extra person fees and resort fees.
- **Taxable receipts exclude** refundable deposits and any additional items included in a special package rate, such as recreational activities subject to CA sales tax.

16. Collection agreements

Reporting by Platform

City of Pasadena, CA has signed collection agreements with Airbnb and Vrbo, so revenue must be reported in three separate groupings. Reporting revenue in the wrong grouping is the most common cause of an incorrect remittance.

- **Vrbo** remits both TOT and TBID directly for all rentals facilitated through their platform.
- **Airbnb** remits TOT directly by default. Hosts who have opted out, or who are part of the Professional Host program, must remit their own TOT to the City directly. Airbnb does not remit other taxes.
- **All Other Platforms —** sum the revenue from every remaining platform and report the total here.



17. Confirm and sign

Confirming the Tax Due

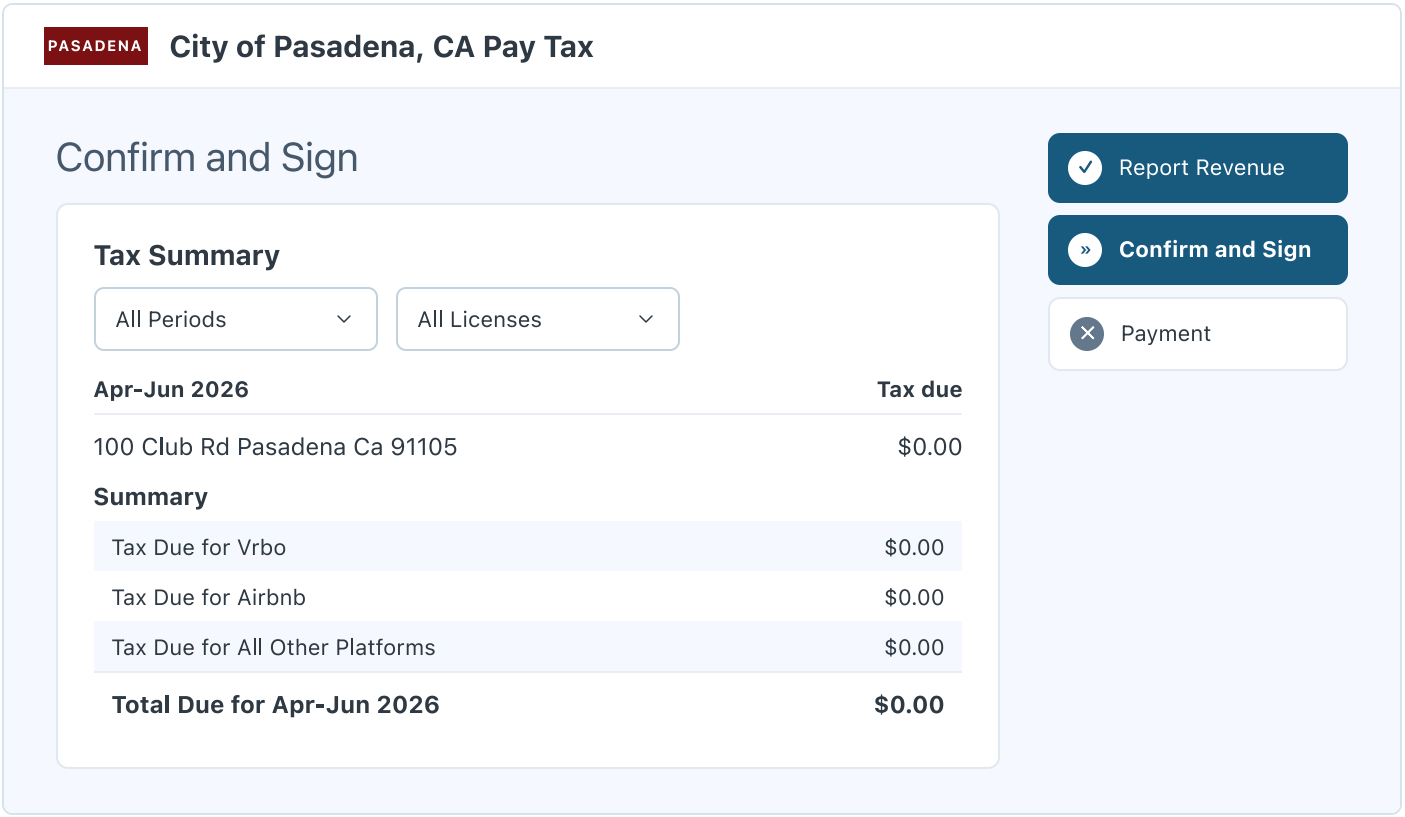
The portal lists each property you have reported for, with the calculated tax payable on the right-hand side. Use the **All Periods** and **All Licenses** filters to narrow the summary.

Click a property address to expand the full calculation. Each platform grouping shows total revenue including all fees, taxable receipts, and then TOT and TBID separately, each with its own due, penalty and interest lines.

> Where a platform already remits a tax on your behalf, that tax calculates as $0.00 for the grouping. A correctly reported quarter can legitimately total $0.00 due. You still complete the submission so the period

is recorded as reported.

Once you have verified your reporting, certify it by checking the box or boxes at the bottom of the page and typing your legal name, then click **Continue** to move to payment.

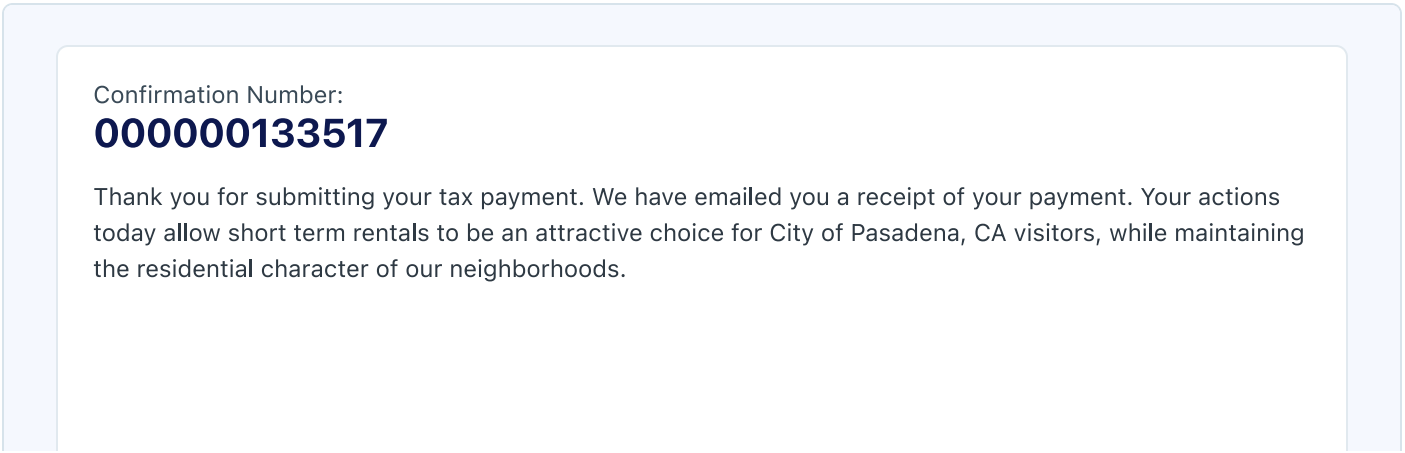


18. Payment and confirmation

Completing Your Remittance

On the final page, complete payment of your taxes through any of the payment methods offered by the City. Follow the steps for the method you select.

The process is complete once you receive a **Confirmation Number** and a message thanking you for submitting your tax payment. You will also receive an email confirming your reporting details and payment. Keep the confirmation number for your records.





19. Reporting history

Viewing Past Reporting

You can view the reporting history for any permit at any time. On the dashboard, click **View** next to the permit. If the permit is not shown in that list, click **See all Permits** for the full list, then select **View** on the permit you want.

Your tax reporting history appears on the left-hand side of the permit page:

- For an unreported period, click **Pay Tax** for that period to begin reporting it.
- For a reported period, click the period to see the full reporting and calculation exactly as it appeared on the Confirm and Sign page.

Getting additional help

If you need further assistance with your permit or your tax reporting, please contact the staff of the City of Pasadena.